



SAVE FOR AMERICA SCHOOL SAVINGS FACT SHEET

Our Mission is...

To inspire a new generation of savers by equipping financial institution partners with tools to build community relationships and promote financial literacy through school-based banking.

About School Savings

School Savings is a social enterprise that enables children to make savings deposits at school through our secure online banking platform. Student deposits are processed electronically through the Federal Reserve Bank. We provide intuitive digital tools that help re-establish the habit of saving among young people. Volunteers generally manage the program at the schools.

Our history

In 1985 School Savings was evaluated and approved as a national financial literacy model by the U.S. Department of Education for ALL students in grades K-8. Many high schools also benefit from the program. Participating in School Savings helps students meet state education requirements in math specifically:

- (1) Uses numbers and computation,**
- (2) Reasons logically and**
- (3) Connects school mathematics to real-life situations**

School Savings is still the only school banking education program to have received this recognition and approval from the US Department of Education.

In 1995 school savings became SCHOOLSAVINGS.COM by accepting its first deposits **online**. More than 3,000,000 million students in 7000+ schools have benefited from the early savings lessons and banking habits they established as school savers.

How does it Work?

Once a week, students bring their savings to school and make a deposit into their savings account before class or during lunch. A PTO Volunteer takes the student deposits to a local financial institution. Through the Federal Reserve Banking System, Websaver® credits all the students' accounts with their deposits. Student deposits appear on the student's regular bank statement. The average deposit, including birthday cash, is around \$10.00. Statistics show that eighty percent (80%) of students are still saving two years later.

Parents and students together maintain an online Savings Register and set savings goals using an animated online Savings Goal application. Contests and incentives keep students excited while the savings habit is “under construction.”

Recognition

In recognition of its role in promoting financial literacy, Save For America School Savings has received support or approval from the following organizations. In 1995, it also received the National Savings Award from CSIA as Best Community Partner.

U.S. Department of Education	The White House 1991 (President George H. Bush)
The Federal Reserve – San Francisco Branch	National Association of Elementary School Principals
National Press Club	National Association of School Directors
Governors and Cabinets of Eight States Including Texas and Florida	Twenty-four State Treasurers
American Bankers Association, Forty State Banking Associations	Community Bankers Association

Research on Saving

Recent U.S. research indicates that savings and assets are important for both household financial stability and children's long-term educational outcomes. Household savings can help families manage financial shocks and reduce economic stress, while child-focused savings programs have been associated with stronger educational pathways, including increased college enrollment and persistence (Congressional Research Service [CRS], 2025; Elliott, 2020). Reviews of Children's Savings Account programs suggest that even modest assets may support children's expectations for postsecondary education and promote long-term opportunity, especially for students from lower-income or historically underserved households (CRS, 2025; University of Michigan, n.d.).

Contact Information:

School Savings
Greater Puget Sound

Tel | 888-787-7728
support@schoolsavings.com
www.schoolsavings.com
www.saveforamerica.org